

THE PERFECTIONIST

BECAUSE he doesn't allow his talent to be bought. Because he could reject Adlabs' three-film cheque for Rs 30 crore on the grounds that there was no script. Because he directed a movie that had audiences queueing up to cry, turning a Rs 12-crore sleeper into an over Rs 100 crore hit. Because with every film, he acquires a faithful new constituency, whether it is activists through *Rang De Basanti* or children through *Taare Zameen Par*. Because at Rs 20-crore-plus revenue share for his next action thriller, a remake of a Tamil hit, he is one of the highest paid actors in Bollywood.

COOL MOVE: Sought an appointment with Amitabh Bachchan to apologise after the superstar was ticked off by his remarks on *Black*.

THE BIG ACQUISITION: A Rs 60-lakh gym in the garage of his flat in Mumbai's Pali Hill.

STRANGE BUT TRUE: Has trouble spelling and says he is probably dyslexic.

TAKES READING TIPS: From son Junaid, 14, who has moved on from Harry Potter to *Artemis Fowl*.

MORE THAN AN ACTOR, HE HAS BECOME A ONE-MAN MOVEMENT FOR BETTER CINEMA.



BHASKAR PAUL